



PRELUDE
LEARNING & CONSULTANCY

FREE RESOURCE · GOVERNANCE & ASSURANCE

Learning Governance Health Check

Twelve questions to test whether your learning and training governance is owned, evidenced and actually working.

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BEFORE YOU START

About this health check

Good learning governance does two things. It gives leaders confidence that people are trained to the standard the organisation needs, and it tells them early when that is no longer true.

Governance that only produces reports, or that springs into action before an inspection, does neither. This health check looks at twelve areas that together determine whether learning governance is doing its job. It applies to any organisation that relies on training for safety, compliance, quality or service: Defence and public bodies, healthcare, housing, regulated industries and commercial businesses.

How to use it

1. Agree the scope: the whole organisation, one function, or one programme.
2. For each question, read “what good looks like”, look for the evidence listed and tick the response that best reflects what you can **show**, not what you believe.
3. Total the scores and complete the profile on the summary page.
4. Use the risk and action pages to agree what to fix first.

Response scale

Response	Score	Meaning
Established and evidenced	3	In place, working consistently and you can produce evidence today.
Partly in place	2	Exists but is incomplete, inconsistent across areas, or poorly evidenced.
Informal or inconsistent	1	Depends on individuals or happens occasionally; little or no evidence.
Not in place or don't know	0	Absent, or nobody can say whether it happens.

AN INDICATIVE SELF-ASSESSMENT

This health check is a structured self-assessment. It is not an audit, does not test your arrangements against any specific regulation or standard, and does not guarantee compliance or a successful audit or inspection outcome. Where you are subject to a defined framework (for example JSP 822 in Defence, a regulator's standards or an awarding body's requirements), assess against that framework directly as well.

PART 1

The twelve questions

01 Is there a named, senior owner accountable for learning and training governance, with the authority to act?

AREA: GOVERNANCE OWNERSHIP

What good looks like

A named individual owns learning governance, reports to a board or senior committee, and has the authority and resources to act on what governance reveals.

Evidence to look for

- Terms of reference or a governance charter
- Board or committee papers showing learning governance is reviewed
- Decisions or actions taken as a result

Established and evidenced 3	Partly in place 2	Informal or inconsistent 1	Not in place or don't know 0
☐	☐	☐	☐

Risk if weak: Problems are seen but nobody has the authority to fix them; governance becomes reporting without action.

02 Are responsibilities for setting requirements, designing, delivering and assuring training defined and understood?

AREA: ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

What good looks like

Responsibilities are documented (for example in a RACI), the people named know what they own, and requirement-setting is separated from delivery so that one checks the other.

Evidence to look for

- RACI or responsibility matrix
- Role descriptions
- Evidence that people can describe their governance role

Established and evidenced 3	Partly in place 2	Informal or inconsistent 1	Not in place or don't know 0
☐	☐	☐	☐

Risk if weak: Gaps and overlaps; nobody challenges training that is poorly specified or poorly delivered.

03 Is every significant programme based on a defined requirement, linked to role, regulatory or business need?

AREA: TRAINING REQUIREMENTS

What good looks like

Each programme can be traced to a documented need: a role requirement, a regulatory obligation, a risk or a business outcome. New requests are tested before content is built.

Evidence to look for

- Training needs analyses or requirement statements
- A process for challenging new training requests
- Traceability from programme to need

Established and evidenced 3	Partly in place 2	Informal or inconsistent 1	Not in place or don't know 0
☐	☐	☐	☐

Risk if weak: Training is built on request rather than need; spend rises without a link to performance.

04 Are there agreed standards and approval points for designing and changing learning?

AREA: DESIGN CONTROLS

What good looks like

Design follows an agreed method with defined review and sign-off points. Subject matter experts and requirement owners approve content before release.

Evidence to look for

- Design standards or templates
- Records of design review and approval
- Accessibility and quality criteria

Established and evidenced 3	Partly in place 2	Informal or inconsistent 1	Not in place or don't know 0
☐	☐	☐	☐

Risk if weak: Inconsistent quality; content that does not match the requirement or is inaccessible to some learners.

05 Is the quality of learning materials and delivery checked routinely, not only when something goes wrong?

AREA: QUALITY ASSURANCE

What good looks like

A planned assurance schedule covers both materials and delivery, using observation and review, with findings recorded and acted upon.

Evidence to look for

- Assurance schedule or plan
- Observation or review records
- Evidence of follow-up actions

Established and evidenced 3	Partly in place 2	Informal or inconsistent 1	Not in place or don't know 0
☐	☐	☐	☐

Risk if weak: Quality problems are discovered by learners, managers, auditors or incidents rather than by the organisation.

06 Can you tell which version of each course or document is current, who approved it and what changed?

AREA: VERSION CONTROL

What good looks like

Learning materials are held in a controlled location with version numbers, approval records, change history and review dates.

Evidence to look for

- Document or content register
- Change logs
- Review dates and evidence they are met

Established and evidenced 3	Partly in place 2	Informal or inconsistent 1	Not in place or don't know 0
☐	☐	☐	☐

Risk if weak: Out-of-date or uncontrolled content in use; inability to show what a learner was taught at a given time.

07 Are the people who design, deliver and assess training competent for that role, and is this kept current?

AREA: DELIVERY COMPETENCE

What good looks like

Trainers, facilitators and assessors have defined competence requirements, are assessed against them and maintain currency in both subject and delivery skills.

Evidence to look for

- Trainer or assessor competence requirements
- Records of qualification, observation or CPD
- Subject currency checks

Established and evidenced 3	Partly in place 2	Informal or inconsistent 1	Not in place or don't know 0
☐	☐	☐	☐

Risk if weak: Inconsistent delivery; learners taught outdated practice; assessments that cannot be relied upon.

08 Do assessments test whether learners can perform to the required standard?

AREA: ASSESSMENT

What good looks like

Assessments are linked to the objectives and the workplace standard, are applied consistently and, where it matters, test performance rather than recall.

Evidence to look for

- Assessment specifications linked to objectives
- Moderation or standardisation records
- Pass and fail data

Established and evidenced 3	Partly in place 2	Informal or inconsistent 1	Not in place or don't know 0
☐	☐	☐	☐

Risk if weak: People are signed off as competent who cannot perform the task; or capable people fail unfair assessments.

09 Does the organisation evaluate whether learning changes behaviour and outcomes, not only whether learners enjoyed it?

AREA: EVALUATION

What good looks like

Evaluation is planned before delivery, includes measures of workplace behaviour and outcomes where proportionate, and results are used to improve or stop programmes.

Evidence to look for

- Evaluation plans
- Data beyond satisfaction scores
- Examples of programmes changed or stopped as a result

Established and evidenced 3	Partly in place 2	Informal or inconsistent 1	Not in place or don't know 0
☐	☐	☐	☐

Risk if weak: Investment continues in programmes that do not work; success is claimed on activity data alone.

10 Are training records accurate, complete and accessible to the people who need them?

AREA: DATA AND RECORDS

What good looks like

Records of who has completed what, to which standard and when, are reliable, reconciled with workforce data, and held in line with data protection requirements.

Evidence to look for

- Training records system and data quality checks
- Reconciliation with HR or workforce data
- Retention and access arrangements

Established and evidenced 3	Partly in place 2	Informal or inconsistent 1	Not in place or don't know 0
☐	☐	☐	☐

Risk if weak: Compliance cannot be demonstrated; leaders make decisions on incorrect data.

11 Are learning-related risks identified, owned and reviewed?

AREA: RISK MANAGEMENT

What good looks like

Risks such as mandatory training gaps, single points of failure in delivery, supplier dependency and outdated content are on a risk register with owners and actions.

Evidence to look for

- Risk register entries for learning
- Risk owners and review dates
- Escalation route

Established and evidenced 3	Partly in place 2	Informal or inconsistent 1	Not in place or don't know 0
☐	☐	☐	☐

Risk if weak: Risks crystallise without warning, often at inspection or after an incident.

12 Is there a routine for checking against external requirements and improving the learning system?

AREA: COMPLIANCE AND CONTINUOUS IMPROVEMENT

What good looks like

Regulatory, contractual or policy requirements are known and mapped; findings from assurance, evaluation and feedback lead to tracked improvements.

Evidence to look for

- Map of applicable requirements
- Improvement log or action tracker
- Evidence of closed actions

Established and evidenced 3	Partly in place 2	Informal or inconsistent 1	Not in place or don't know 0
☐	☐	☐	☐

Risk if weak: The same findings recur; the organisation reacts to audits rather than anticipating them.

PART 2

Summary and interpretation

#	Area	Score (0-3)	Main evidence relied on
01	Governance ownership		
02	Roles and responsibilities		
03	Training requirements		
04	Design controls		
05	Quality assurance		
06	Version control		
07	Delivery competence		
08	Assessment		
09	Evaluation		
10	Data and records		
11	Risk management		
12	Compliance and continuous improvement		
Total (maximum 36)			

Reading your profile

The total gives a rough indication. The pattern matters more: a single weak area can undermine several strong ones.

30–36	Established	Governance is largely in place and evidenced. Focus on evaluation, continuous improvement and keeping arrangements proportionate.
21–29	Developing	Foundations exist but there are gaps an auditor, regulator or incident could expose. Prioritise areas scored 0 or 1.
12–20	Fragile	Governance depends on individuals and goodwill. Agree ownership and the minimum controls before adding activity.
0–11	Weak	The organisation is unlikely to be able to show that people are trained to the required standard. Treat as a priority risk.

These bands are Prelude guidance to support discussion. They are not a validated scoring model.

FOUNDATION AREAS

Weakness in **01 Ownership**, **03 Training requirements** or **10 Data and records** tends to undermine everything else: without an owner, a defined requirement and reliable records, the other controls have nothing firm to work on. If any of these scored 0 or 1, start there regardless of your total.

PART 3

Risks, priorities and improvement plan

Risk identification

For each area scored 0 or 1, describe the risk in your own context. Rate likelihood and impact as High, Medium or Low.

Area #	Risk in our context	Likelihood	Impact	Risk owner

Priority actions

Choose no more than three to five actions for the next 90 days. Foundation areas first; then the highest-rated risks.

#	Action	Area #	Owner	Due	Evidence it is done
1					
2					
3					
4					
5					

Twelve-month improvement plan

Period	Improvements planned	How we will know they are working
0–3 months		
3–6 months		
6–12 months		
Date of next health check		

Working with Prelude

Prelude helps organisations design governance and assurance that is proportionate and useful: arrangements that support good decisions rather than generate paperwork. Work ranges from an independent review of current arrangements to designing governance frameworks, assurance schedules and evaluation approaches.

Independent review

An evidence-based view of your governance against your own requirements.

Framework design

Ownership, controls and assurance scaled to your risk.

Discuss a challenge

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